CHANTILLY, FRANCE

Musée Condé: Masterpieces

Twenty paintings at the Musée Condé, where an object in the hand can change the meaning of a figure.



Marie-Antoinette holds the attributes of Hebe without ceasing to look like a court sitter. Nearby in this selection, a woman traditionally identified as Simonetta Vespucci is given a serpent, but no fully secure name. A likeness can be specific while the identity or role attached to it remains complicated.

The Musée Condé's paintings make such distinctions worth keeping. Their figures act as saints, mythological beings, military leaders, musicians and named individuals. Sometimes a small gesture is enough to organise the image: lifting a veil, withholding a bow or raising a hand. The twenty entries follow these actions, while preserving the difference between an original painting, a sketch and an uncertain identification.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/musee-conde-chantilly

The selection · 20

1. The Madonna of Loreto
   Raphael · c. 1509–1510
2. Portrait of a Woman, Said to Be Simonetta Vespucci
   Piero di Cosimo · 1490
3. Self-Portrait at the Age of Twenty-Four
   Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres · 1804
4. Madame Antonia de Vauçay, Born de Nittis
   Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres · 1807
5. Venus Anadyomene
   Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres · 1807-1848
6. Five Dancing Angels
   Giovanni di Paolo · c. 1436
7. The Serenader
   Jean-Antoine Watteau · 1715
8. Love Disarmed
   Jean-Antoine Watteau · c. 1715
9. Horse Leaving a Stable
   Théodore Géricault · 1810
10. A Pyrenean Shepherd
    Rosa Bonheur · 1864
11. The Childhood of Bacchus
    Nicolas Poussin · c. 1630
12. The Christ Child, Saviour of the World
    Bernardino Luini · c. 1520
13. Esther Chosen by Ahasuerus
    LIPPI Filippino · c. 1480
14. Count Henri de Bergh
    Anthony van Dyck · 1625-1629
15. Marie-Antoinette as Hebe
    François-Hubert Drouais · 1773
16. The Ham Luncheon
    Nicolas Lancret · 1735
17. Bonaparte Visiting the Plague-Stricken at Jaffa: Chantilly Version
    Antoine-Jean Gros · c. 1802
18. In the Abruzzi
    Oswald Achenbach · 1863
19. Heron Hunt in Algeria
    Eugène Fromentin · 1865
20. The Angel Gabriel with Musical Angels and Cherubs
    Annibale Carracci · Second half of the 16th century

01 / 20

The Madonna of Loreto

Raphael

c. 1509–1510 · Oil on poplar · Musée Condé



Raphael. LA VIERGE DE LORETTE. WikiArt: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt per-object label)

The veil joins two movements: Mary's careful lifting and the child's reaching arms. Joseph remains farther back in shadow, watching an action that brings the foreground figures together. The sacred family is organised around this small material connection. The cloth can be thin and almost transparent while still providing the group's most consequential link.

Object source · Open artwork

02 / 20

Portrait of a Woman, Said to Be Simonetta Vespucci

Piero di Cosimo

1490 · Musée Condé



Piero di Cosimo. Portrait of a Woman, said to be of Simonetta Vespucci. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The precise profile gives the sitter an apparently stable identity, then the serpent and dark clouds complicate it. The traditional name Simonetta Vespucci remains qualified, and the attributes should not be used to make that identification certain. Portrait-like specificity and uncertainty about who is represented are both part of looking at this work.

Object source · Open artwork

03 / 20

Self-Portrait at the Age of Twenty-Four

Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres

1804 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres. Self-Portrait at the Age of 24. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/jean-auguste-dominique-ingres/self-portrait-at-the-age-of-24 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The painter turns from his task and meets the outward view, bringing work and self-presentation into the same pose. His pale shirt separates the upper body from the dark coat. The interruption is constructed within a self-portrait: the person who seems to have paused is also responsible for arranging the encounter.

Object source · Open artwork

04 / 20

Madame Antonia de Vauçay, Born de Nittis

Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres

1807 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres. Portrait of Madame Antonia de Vaucay nee de Nittis. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/jean-auguste-dominique-ingres/portrait-of-madame-antonia-de-vaucay-nee-de-nittis-1807 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

Joined hands rest within the larger enclosure of dress, shawl and chair. The red furniture gives the seated body a firmer boundary, while the hands offer a quieter internal centre. Ingres holds the portrait together through these nested curves, allowing a slight change in face or posture to matter within a controlled arrangement.

Object source · Open artwork

05 / 20

Venus Anadyomene

Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres

1807-1848 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Jean-Auguste-Dominique Ingres. VENUS ANADYOMENE. Image: WikiArt. Public domain (WikiArt label). Proportionally resized and JPEG compressed; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt label)

The long pale body holds a sustained pose above much smaller winged figures. The extended development of the painting also matters: Ingres began the project during his early years in Rome and completed it in 1848. Its apparent stillness is the product of prolonged work, not evidence that the whole design arrived at once.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 433

06 / 20

Five Dancing Angels

Giovanni di Paolo

c. 1436 · Oil and gold on softwood · Musée Condé



Giovanni di Paolo. CINQ ANGES DANSANT. Image credit: Giovanni di Paolo; Own work , Jebulon , 2011-07-03. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Angels_dancing_sun_Giovanni_di_Paolo_Cond%C3%A9_Chantilly.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The joined hands make a continuous connection through the five bodies, including those whose backs turn outward. Folds and alternating poses give the group movement against gold without a deep space into which they can travel. The dance is read through repeated changes of orientation within the circle itself.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 9

07 / 20

The Serenader

Jean-Antoine Watteau

1715 · Oil on panel · Musée Condé



The Serenader. WikiArt; Jean-Antoine Watteau. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

The crossed legs and the instrument's diagonal give the musician a pose that seems already shaped by performance. Costume frames the face but does not carry the action alone. Watteau makes the body participate in the music, allowing a silent picture to describe something of playing through stance and direction.

Object source · Open artwork

08 / 20

Love Disarmed

Jean-Antoine Watteau

c. 1715 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Antoine Watteau. L'AMOUR DESARME. WikiArt: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt per-object label)

Cupid reaches for a bow held beyond him. The modest gap between hand and object supplies the whole exchange with its action, while the oval keeps the two bodies close. An allegory of disarmed love is made legible through a familiar imbalance: one figure can possess what the other wants but cannot yet reach.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 369

09 / 20

Horse Leaving a Stable

Théodore Géricault

1810 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Horse leaving a Stable. WikiArt; Théodore Géricault. Proportional resizing and JPEG compression; source frame preserved. · Public domain

The lifted foreleg places the horse between standing and moving out of the stable. A nearby handler shares that narrow threshold, while light distinguishes the animal's weight from the darker doorway. The scene depends on this unresolved transition; it would change substantially if the horse were already in an open landscape.

Object source · Open artwork

10 / 20

A Pyrenean Shepherd

Rosa Bonheur

1864 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Rosa Bonheur. Berger des Pyrénées. Image credit: Rosa Bonheur; Own work; Photographic credit: Dguendel. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Ch%C3%A2teau_de_Chantilly,_Rosa_Bonheur,_sheeps_in_the_Pyrenees.JPG. CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY 4.0

The staff, animals and rough ground define a shared working environment. The shepherd does not appear simply to ornament a mountain view, and the animals are not interchangeable patches of rural colour. Differences of posture and texture make their relation to the terrain specific enough to sustain the picture without a dramatic event.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 531

11 / 20

The Childhood of Bacchus

Nicolas Poussin

c. 1630 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Nicolas Poussin. Nurture of Bacchus. WikiArt source label: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. Source: https://www.wikiart.org/en/nicolas-poussin/nurture-of-bacchus-1635 · Public domain (WikiArt source label)

The infant occupies a gathering broken into smaller relations among figures and satyrs. Gestures connect these episodes across the woodland setting, so the myth can be followed without every body merging into a crowd. Poussin gives the scene a readable social organisation before each participant's identity has been established.

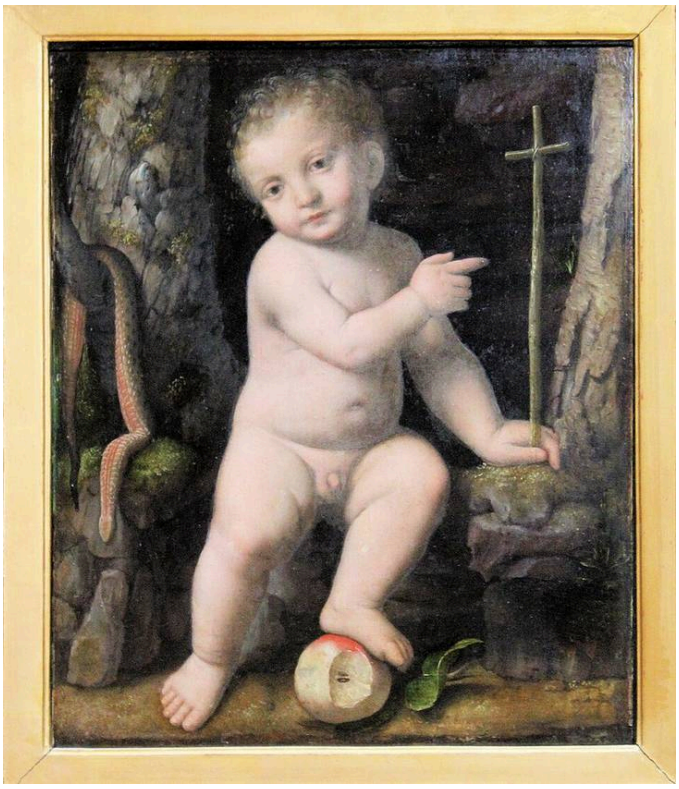
Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 298

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The Christ Child, Saviour of the World

Bernardino Luini

c. 1520 · Oil on wood · Musée Condé



Bernardino Luini. L'ENFANT JESUS, SAUVEUR DU MONDE. Image credit: Bernardino Luini; Own work; Photographic credit: Dguendel. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Ch%C3%A2teau_de_Chantilly,_Bernardino_Luini,_Jesu_as_a_child.JPG. CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY 4.0

The child's small body is accompanied by a raised hand, cross-staff and orb, signs whose claims exceed his physical scale. Their separation makes that difference legible. The image joins infancy to spiritual authority rather than asking one to cancel the other; the clear silhouette keeps both present.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 24

13 / 20

Esther Chosen by Ahasuerus

LIPPI Filippino

c. 1480 · Tempera on wood · Musée Condé



Filippino Lippi. Esther choisie par Assuérus. WikiArt: Public domain. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain (WikiArt per-object label)

Arcades divide the wide panel into connected spaces, giving the courtly story more than one place to unfold. Bright clothing distinguishes groups within this repeated architecture. The royal throne supplies a focus, but the panel's breadth allows attention to travel between participants rather than stopping permanently at one central figure.

Object source · Open artwork

14 / 20

Count Henri de Bergh

Anthony van Dyck

1625-1629 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Anthony van Dyck. PORTRAIT DU COMTE HENRI DE BERGHE. Image credit: Anthony van Dyck; Base Joconde. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Portrait_du_comte_Henri_de_Berghe_-_Anton_van_Dyck_-_Mus%C3%A9e_Cond%C3%A9.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Armour makes much of the body appear enclosed and resistant, while the face and hand remain comparatively exposed. The hand's position near the sword joins those living features to military equipment. Van Dyck presents rank through a composed arrangement, giving its wearer an individual presence without stripping away the role that clothing declares.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 126

15 / 20

Marie-Antoinette as Hebe

François-Hubert Drouais

1773 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



François-Hubert Drouais. Madame la Dauphine Marie-Antoinette, en Hébé. Image credit: François-Hubert Drouais; Jebulon (talk · contribs) (2011). https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Marie_Antoinette_dauphine_H%C3%A9b%C3%A9_Drouais_Chantilly.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The jug and eagle identify Hebe, while the face and elaborately dressed hair preserve the conventions of a royal portrait. Marie-Antoinette is therefore represented in a role, not replaced by an anonymous mythological figure. The costume offers a classical framework through which a specific public identity can be presented.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 395

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The Ham Luncheon

Nicolas Lancret

1735 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Nicolas Lancret. LE DEJEUNER DE JAMBON. Image credit: Nicolas Lancret; Joconde database : entry 00000076666. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:D%C3%A9jeuner_de_jambon_-_Nicolas_Lancret_-_mus%C3%A9e_Cond%C3%A9.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The white tablecloth gathers the meal into one bright area, but bottles below and gestures around it keep the company from settling into a formal group portrait. The park provides room for sociability to spread. Several small exchanges can coexist without one diner being made the unquestioned centre of the occasion.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 383

17 / 20

Bonaparte Visiting the Plague-Stricken at Jaffa: Chantilly Version

Antoine-Jean Gros

c. 1802 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Antoine-Jean Gros. BONAPARTE, GENERAL EN CHEF DE L'ARMEE D'ORIENT, TOUCHE UNE TUMEUR PESTILENTIELLE, EN VISITANT LES PESTIFERES DANS L'HOPITAL DE JAFFA. Image credit: Antoine-Jean Gros; Own work , Pierre Poschadel , 2019-09-22. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Chantilly_(60),_mus%C3%A9e_Cond%C3%A9,_Antoine_Jean_Baron_Gros,_Bonaparte_et_les_pestif%C3%A9r%C3%A9s_de_Jaffa,_1804.jpg. CC BY-SA 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/4.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY-SA 4.0

Bonaparte's approach to the sick is made conspicuous within the arcaded enclosure. Light separates bodies and turns the act into a public presentation of leadership. The Chantilly work is catalogued as a sketch related to the larger Louvre painting; it should be read as its own object, not treated as an interchangeable reproduction of that version.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 428

18 / 20

In the Abruzzi

Oswald Achenbach

1863 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Oswald Achenbach. DANS LES ABRUZZES. Image credit: Oswald Achenbach; Own work , 2017-08-30, Dguendel. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Ch%C3%A2teau_de_Chantilly,_Oswald_Achenbach,_in_the_Abruzzo.JPG. CC BY 4.0 (https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · CC BY 4.0

A roadside shrine gives the travellers a reason to stop while the road continues toward distant mountains. The landscape contains both pause and passage, measured by figures at different distances. The journey is organised through places that can be occupied briefly, rather than through an uninterrupted prospect seen from outside human use.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 606

19 / 20

Heron Hunt in Algeria

Eugène Fromentin

1865 · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Eugène Fromentin. LA CHASSE AU HERON (ALGERIE). Image credit: Eugène Fromentin; Jebulon , Own work. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Chasse_au_h%C3%A9ron_Fromentin_Mus%C3%A9e_Cond%C3%A9.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

The hunters remain widely separated across shallow water, with birds and riders interrupting a low horizon. That spacing makes distance part of the action: the hunt cannot be reduced to one close encounter. The large sky also keeps the figures within an extensive setting instead of allowing their movement to fill the whole picture.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 528

20 / 20

The Angel Gabriel with Musical Angels and Cherubs

Annibale Carracci

Second half of the 16th century · Oil on canvas · Musée Condé



Annibale Carracci. L'ANGE GABRIEL DANS UNE GLOIRE D'ANGES MUSICIENS ET DE CHERUBINS. Image credit: Annibale Carracci; Joconde database : entry 00000077351. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Annibale_Carracci,_Arcangelo_Gabriele,_Museo_Cond%C3%A9.jpg. Public domain (https://creativecommons.org/publicdomain/mark/1.0/). Full-frame proportional resize and JPEG compression; applicable ShareAlike terms retained. · Public domain

Gabriel's open arms give the surrounding ascent a clear point of attention. Blue and red clothing distinguish the central body, while smaller angels and clouds continue the movement around it. The heavenly gathering is held together through direction and colour rather than a ground plane on which all the figures could stand.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: PE 62

Keep the object distinct from its story

A familiar subject may survive in several versions, and a traditional name may be less certain than a face appears. Use the linked records to keep those distinctions clear. Consult the château's current visiting information separately; this selection does not specify a route or guarantee the availability of every object.

Further reading

A Treatise on Painting

Leonardo da Vinci; translated by John Francis Rigaud · Read free · English

Leonardo's Treatise on Painting, in an English translation, discusses gesture, light and the observation of bodies. Those topics provide a useful historical reading alongside the figures by Raphael, Piero di Cosimo and Ingres, without implying that each followed the treatise.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12